



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Augustine Classical Academy
School Website: <https://augustineca.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Augustine Classical Academy (Mechanicville, NY)

Website used: <https://augustineca.org/>

Executive Summary

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Why: The school explicitly articulates a classical Christian philosophy grounded in Scripture and the liberal arts; it implements the Trivium across Grammar, Dialectic, and Rhetoric stages; and it evidences hallmark pedagogies (chanting/recitation in lower grades; Socratic dialogue, debates, speeches, a thesis and viva voce in upper school). Parent partnership and community formation are unusually strong. Some marketing emphasis on AP/SAT metrics and a stated "project-based learning" emphasis are mild divergences from traditional classical signals but do not outweigh the substantial classical evidence.

Highlights: - Christ-centered, Scripture-integrated academics; repeated references to "wisdom," "truth, goodness, and beauty," and a "biblical worldview" across pages.

- Trivium structure with formal logic, rhetoric, great ideas/books, Great Works of Theology, Latin (3rd grade) and Greek through senior year, primary sources, and a capstone thesis with viva voce.
- Robust pedagogy: chanting/singing/recitation in the Grammar School; graded Socratic discussions, debates, speeches, and a 30-page thesis defense in the Upper School; explicit cultivation of "wonder."
- Parent partnership is explicit and practiced: in loco parentis framing, parents present during the day, and a classical book club with parents and faculty.

Note on method: Keyword analysis below uses the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from the Six Essential Elements framework and lexicon to ground ratings (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, Socratic, scholé, wonder, chanting, project-based, etc.).

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

- Evidence from the site:
 - Positive keywords found in public materials: "classical Christian education," "love for Jesus," "wisdom," "beauty," "True and Good," "Scripture," "biblical worldview," "Christocentricity of the Old Testament," "Great Works of Theology," "Christian Foundations" (course).
 - Comparison to Six Elements positive indicators: Matches on transcendental moral realism and theological grounding: truth/goodness/beauty; wisdom; theology; Scripture; Christian worldview; integration across disciplines (e.g., "Christocentricity of the Old Testament," Great Works of Theology). Liturgical/chapel language is not explicitly present in the crawl.
- Quantification (keyword hits):
 - Positive hits: 12 (truth/goodness/beauty, wisdom, Christ/Jesus, Scripture, Christian worldview, theology integration, Christocentricity, Great Works of Theology, etc.)

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- Negative hits: 0
 - percent_positive: 100%
 - percent_coverage (of subelements: transcendental values, theology, liturgy): 67% (no explicit liturgy/chapel reference found)
 - pos_neg_hits: +12/-0
 - Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

- Evidence from the site:
 - Positive keywords: “cultivate ... wisdom,” “virtuous,” “discipleship,” “truth,” “good,” “beauty,” “love of learning,” “biblical worldview.” Education described as forming articulate and virtuous followers of Christ; “all education is discipleship; nothing is neutral.”
 - Negative indicators: Marketing emphasizes “Variety of AP courses,” “average SAT score,” and a long college admissions list, which are associated with pragmatic/metrics-driven signaling (a classical caution).
 - Mapping to Six Elements: Purpose language strongly aligns with cultivation of wisdom/virtue and pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; however, measurable outcomes and AP/SAT focus are mild negatives in the classical framework.
- Quantification:
 - Positive hits: 8 (wisdom/virtue/discipleship/TGB/love of learning/biblical worldview, etc.)
 - Negative hits: 4 (AP, SAT, college outcomes emphasis)
 - percent_positive: 65%
 - percent_coverage: 100% (addresses virtue/wisdom, formation, and TGB themes)
 - pos_neg_hits: +8/-4
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

- Evidence from the site:
 - Positive keywords: Trivium explicitly named; “Grammar, Dialectic, Rhetoric”; formal logic and classical rhetoric; “great ideas” and “great books of the western tradition”; “Great Works of Theology”; Latin from 3rd grade; Latin and Greek through senior year; “primary sources” in history; chronological history; rhetoric capstone with 30-page thesis and viva voce.
 - Negative signals: “Socratic and project based learning emphasis” includes the phrase “project based,” a mild negative if it dominates; here it appears alongside Socratic methods and classical elements.
 - Mapping to Six Elements: Strong alignment with Trivium, great books, classical languages, primary texts, and integration/wonder.
- Quantification:
 - Positive hits: 14 (Trivium terms, logic, rhetoric, Latin, Greek, Great Books/Ideas/Works of Theology, primary sources, history, thesis/viva voce)
 - Negative hits: 1 (“project-based learning” called out in hallmarks)
 - percent_positive: 93%
 - percent_coverage: 100% (Trivium, history, Great Books/primary sources, wonder)
 - pos_neg_hits: +14/-1
- Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY OR TEACHING METHODS

- Evidence from the site:
 - Positive keywords: Lower school “sing, chant, recite” (memory work); students “memorize Scripture from their earliest years”; Upper school “graded Socratic discussions,” “debates,” “speeches,” capstone thesis with viva voce; explicit mention of cultivating “wonder.”
 - Negative signals: “project□based learning” is named in school hallmarks; in the classical lexicon, a dominant experiential/project□only posture is a negative, though here it is paired with Socratic practice.
 - Mapping to Six Elements: Strong matches for chanting/memorization and Socratic/rhetoric practice; no explicit “scholé/restful learning” language found.
- Quantification:
 - Positive hits: 9 (singing/chanting/recitation/memorization/Socratic/debate/speeches/thesis/viva voce/wonder)
 - Negative hits: 1 (“project□based learning”)
 - percent_positive: 90%
 - percent_coverage: 80% (no explicit scholé/restfulness, but strong evidence on other elements)
 - pos_neg_hits: +9/-1
- Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY

- Evidence from the site:
 - Positive keywords: Presence of a formal “Portrait of Augustine Faculty” (teacher profile ideal); “teachers gently shepherd students’ hearts”; close teacher supervision in thesis work.
 - Mapping to Six Elements: Indicates mentors/living curriculum and explicit teacher profile; fewer public claims about collegial culture or faculty formation on the site pages crawled.
- Quantification:
 - Positive hits: 3 (portrait of faculty; mentoring/shepherding; supervised thesis mentorship)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - percent_positive: 100%
 - percent_coverage: 60% (some, but not all, faculty criteria surfaced in public pages)
 - pos_neg_hits: +3/-0
- Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

- Evidence from the site:
 - Positive keywords: “We partner with parents” and “parents hold primary responsibility”; in loco parentis articulated; parents welcome and present during the day (“join their children for lunch,” “halls are regularly filled with parents”); classical parent formation via St. Augustine’s Book Club with parents and teachers.
 - Mapping to Six Elements: Strong alignment with parental primacy/partnership and parent formation practices.
- Quantification:
 - Positive hits: 6 (partnership, in loco parentis, open campus/visits, parent□teacher meetings, book club, volunteering/events)
 - Negative hits: 0
 - percent_positive: 100%
 - percent_coverage: 100%

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- pos_neg_hits: +6/-0
 - Rating: CLASSICAL

Overall Classification

- Aggregate rating: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: Four categories are CLASSICAL (Religious & Metaphysical, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Parents & Community). Two categories are SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (Purpose & Goal and Faculty) due to visible metrics/college marketing and limited public detail on teacher formation/collegiality. The breadth and clarity of classical commitments (Trivium, great books, classical languages, Socratic/rhetoric capstones, chanting/recitation, Scriptural integration, and robust parent partnership) outweigh the noted divergences.

Evidence Appendix: On-site phrases (sampled) mapped to the Six Elements lexicon

- Truth, Goodness, Beauty; wisdom; Scripture; theology; Christian worldview; Christ-centered (Religious/Metaphysical, Purpose): “love for Jesus,” “treasures of wisdom and knowledge,” “love what is True and Good ... transcendence of Beauty,” “turn to Scripture,” “Great Works of Theology,” “Christocentricity of the Old Testament,” “all education is discipleship.”
- Trivium, Great Books, classical languages, primary sources (Curriculum): “Dialectic...second stage of the ‘Trivium’,” “Rhetoric...third stage,” “great ideas and great books of the western tradition,” “Latin...Greek through the senior year,” “reading...primary sources.”
- Socratic, chanting, memorization, speeches, debate, thesis/viva voce, wonder (Pedagogy): “graded Socratic discussions,” “sing, chant, recite,” “memorize Scripture,” “speeches, debates,” “30-page thesis...20-minute ‘viva voce’,” “promote wonder.”
- Parents & Community: partnership; open campus; parents’ book club on classical Christian texts; in loco parentis.

Note: The keyword sets and category criteria applied here are taken from the Six Essential Elements framework and lexicon.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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